



the Google Play Store. Tablet users will need to download the app from <http://m.snappea.com/> though as the app on the Play Store doesn't currently support the tablet app. Fire up the desktop and phone apps and you're ready to connect. The software allows you to connect either via Wi-Fi or USB cable. For Wi-Fi, you will be given a unique key that will allow you to pair your device with the PC. To connect via USB, make sure your phone is in "USB debugging mode" as the software will not be able to interact with your device otherwise.

If all goes well, you should see your phone's name and model number listed on the top left corner of the screen. Be warned that if you're using a custom ROM, the name might defer depending on the phone the ROM is based on. Don't worry about it though, as long



Would you like to install this software?

as you see a name and number you should be fine.

Moving on to the apps panel, you can create a complete backup of all the apps on your system. By all, we really mean all, even your default system apps can be backed up in a jiffy. The neat thing that SnapPea manages to do here is that it also backs up all your app data along with the apk file, so all your hard work spent on Temple Run or Angry Birds or even keyboard training will never again be wasted. Isn't that great?

SnapPea lets you backup photos and contacts and messages as well. This is something your Google account does by default on any Android device, but it is nice to have a secondary backup just in case. Backing up

messages with SnapPea is a bit of a hit and miss though. We faced issues where the dates were mixed up and ancient messages were being forced to the fore. For SMSes, try SMS Backup and Restore from the Play Store (we'll talk about it later on in this section).

Backing up and managing music is also quite convenient with this software, especially if you manage your music via iTunes. SnapPea lets you directly import your iTunes library and transfer it to your phone quite easily.

The "downloads" section of this application is one that merits a second, more detailed look. You'll see a whole pile of links there. You can download apps from Imobile and the Google Play store, even YouTube videos and iTunes trailers. All downloads will automatically be transferred

to your phone in the appropriate format. There are links present to sites such as Android Central and Phandroid for those interested.

One very interesting feature of SnapPea is its ability to capture screenshots from your device. The process couldn't be simpler. Connect your device, hit the capture button on your welcome screen and that's it! You've got a screenshot saved in the folder of your choice. The capture tool also lets you view your phone's screen in real-time, perfect for presentations and such. The response when streaming is a little low but it is sufficient if all you want to do is project your screen somewhere.

For those who like to switch ROMs a lot and routinely put their phones

into recovery mode, SnapPea can get quite frustrating if you're using the default configuration. You will need to change the settings that automatically launch SnapPea when a phone is detected as it will interfere with your recovery or flashing process. To do this, go to settings and uncheck both the checkboxes under the "Launch" sub-head. You can also enable or disable auto-backup from this screen.



Save all contacts

rest assured that there is a backup available should you ever want to access them again.



Backing up SMSes

One of the simplest and best tools for backing up messages is the SMS Backup and Restore utility available for free on the Google Play Store. Just download and install it on your phone, accept all the disclaimers and get it up and running.

To backup the messages, hit "Backup", choose your destination folder, name your backup and hit ok. The phone might take a few minutes to complete the task depending on the number of messages you have and voila! You have an editable xml backup of all the messages on your phone. We would recommend saving the backup on an external SD card or something as it would be safer.

Restoring SMSes is as simple as backing them up. Suppose you formatted your phone or flashed it, just download the app again, make sure that your backed up XML file is present on the device and hit restore. Navi-



Backup SMSes, pronto



Backing up contacts and apps

This is a very basic function that Android enables by default, but there are quite a few people who accidentally disable it or don't know about it.

To ensure that your backup and restore service is running you need to go through the following checklist in the settings section of your Android phone.

1. In Accounts and Sync, ensure that you have setup at least one Google account. If you haven't (very unlikely), do so now. After setting it up, or if there is already an account listed, tap on that account and ensure that the checkboxes for syncing your contacts, drive, photos, email, etc. are selected as per your requirement. Note that if you have multiple accounts, items like contacts might overlap in your contacts app. Also, setting up Google+ will actually sync photos with your Google+ account directly on certain phones.
2. In the Backup and Reset option, make sure that "Backup my data" and "Automatically restore" are checked. Also verify that a backup account has been set.